Oluwadamilare Paul Aina

Data Protection Officer | Information Security & GRC Professional

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Information Security and Data Protection professional with 5+ years of cross-sector experience across banking and digital health. Specialises in privacy programme development, information security governance, third-party risk management, and regulatory compliance across NDPA, GDPR, ISO 27001, PCI DSS, SOC 2, and HIPAA frameworks. Certified ISO 27001 Lead Implementer and Lead Auditor, with proven ability to build and audit information security management systems end-to-end. Currently serving as Data Protection Officer for Nigeria's flagship public-private digital health platform (Lagos SHIP) under Interswitch Group, overseeing NDPA and HIPAA compliance across patient-data infrastructure connecting Lagos State healthcare facilities.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Data Protection & Privacy	ISO/IEC 27001 Lead Impl./Auditor	PCI DSS v4.0	GDPR / NDPA / HIPAA / SOC 2	Third-Party Risk Mgmt	DPIA & RoPA
Security Awareness & Training	Incident Response & BCM	AI Security & Governance	IT Audit & Regulatory Reporting	Privacy Framework (ISO 29100)	Cybersecurity Risk (ISO 27032)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Protection Officer | *Digital Health Platforms — Interswitch Group* Feb 2025 – Present

Lagos SHIP (Lagos Smart Health Information Platform) — Nigeria's first state-wide digital health SPV

- Lead NDPA, GDPR, HIPAA, and HITRUST compliance across a multi-stakeholder digital health infrastructure connecting Lagos State public healthcare facilities.
- Own and maintain DPIAs, Record of Processing Activities (RoPA), and data breach register, ensuring full regulatory readiness.
- Manage Data Subject Access Requests (DSARs) end-to-end, coordinating responses within statutory timelines.
- Advise executive management and engineering teams on privacy-by-design principles, data-sharing agreements, and cross-border transfer mechanisms.
- Develop and deliver staff training and awareness programmes on data protection obligations, phishing risks, and incident reporting.
- Engage with external platform partners (Patients Know Best, HMOs) and regulatory bodies on information governance requirements.

Information Security & Third-Party Risk Analyst | *Sterling Financial Holdings Company* Oct 2024 – Feb 2025

- Identified and mitigated cyber risks across internal systems and third-party vendor ecosystems, maintaining a live risk register.
- Led structured vendor due diligence and third-party risk assessments, evaluating controls against ISO 27001 and internal policy baselines.
- Designed and delivered enterprise-wide security awareness campaigns and phishing simulations.
- Monitored emerging cyber threats and advised on control enhancements; produced monthly regulatory compliance reporting dashboards.

Acting Data Protection Officer | *Heritage Bank Plc* Mar 2024 – Jun 2024

Concurrent with Information Security Analyst role below

- Developed and implemented NDPR-compliant data protection policies and procedures, creating the bank's first structured privacy framework.
- Managed privacy impact assessments, breach notification workflows, and DSAR responses within regulatory deadlines.
- Delivered data protection awareness sessions to 300+ staff across multiple branches and business units.
- Liaised with the Nigeria Data Protection Commission (NDPC) on compliance obligations and filing requirements.

Information Security Analyst | *Heritage Bank Plc* Aug 2023 – Jun 2024

- Oversaw selection, deployment, and operationalisation of a Network Detection and Response (NDR) solution, improving threat visibility.
- Conducted security audits and risk assessments across on-premises and cloud infrastructure, producing remediation roadmaps.
- Led company-wide security awareness training and incident response tabletop simulations.
- Collaborated with cloud and engineering teams on vulnerability management and security hardening.

Product Manager — PayDia Agency Banking | *Heritage Bank Plc* Jul 2021 – Oct 2023

- Launched three agency banking applications, introducing digital agent onboarding and streamlining field activation processes.
- Achieved a 40% improvement in platform adoption through targeted UX enhancements and agent engagement programmes.
- Managed the full product lifecycle from strategy and requirements gathering through to rollout, support, and iteration using Agile/Scrum methodology.

Graduate Trainee | *Heritage Bank Plc* Apr 2021 – Jun 2021

- Completed intensive rotational induction programme across retail banking, operations, and digital product divisions.

Sales Associate & Retail Team Lead — Digital Products | *Wema Bank Plc* Jul 2019 – May 2021

- Led a retail team focused on digital product adoption (ALAT by Wema), driving customer onboarding and product education initiatives.
- Developed and executed field sales strategies that exceeded quarterly digital acquisition targets.

EDUCATION

MSc Information Management 2024 – 2027 (In Progress)
Ahmadu Bello University (ABU) — Department of Library and Information Science
Research focus: Information security, data governance, and organisational knowledge management

BSc Business Administration and Management 2013 – 2017
University of Ilorin

LICENCES & CERTIFICATIONS

ISO / IEC Standards

ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Lead Implementer · GRC Lab Feb 2026
ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Lead Auditor · Mastermind · *Expires Nov 2028* Nov 2025
ISO/IEC 29100:2024 Privacy Framework Foundation · Standards & Best Practice Intl. Jul 2025
ISO/IEC 27032:2023 Cybersecurity Guidelines Foundation · Standards & Best Practice Intl. Jan 2026
ISO/IEC 27001:2022 ISMS Foundation · Standards & Best Practice Intl. Jul 2024
ISO/IEC 27001 Information Security Associate · SkillFront Jun 2024

Privacy & Compliance

Certified Data Protection Officer (DPO) · Data Protection Academy — May 2024
PCI DSS v4.0 Practitioner · Standards & Best Practice Intl. — Jul 2024
SOC 2 Compliance Essential Training · LinkedIn Learning — Jun 2025
Building a HIPAA Compliance Program · LinkedIn Learning — Jun 2025
Managing Organisational Risks · Skillsoft — Dec 2025

Cybersecurity & Technical

Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) · ISC2 · *Expires May 2027* — May 2024
AI Security · Securiti AI — Dec 2025
Ethical Hacking Essentials · EC-Council — Aug 2024
Introduction to Cybersecurity · Cisco Networking Academy

Professional Development

Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt · GoLeanSixSigma — Apr 2025
AI Augmented Professional Skills · ALX Africa — Aug 2024
Agile Scrum Foundation · Simplilearn — Jul 2022

PUBLICATION

Aina, O. P. (2017). The Impact of Innovation on the Performance of SMEs. Undergraduate Research, University of Ilorin, Nigeria.

References available upon request